



54 | When we brought in apprenticeship, they said ‘Oh, that’s not a job... you’re only doing apprenticeship. And therefore you’re not creating jobs.’ But you made apprenticeship a right. So, apprenticeship is not a job when we give it, but apprenticeship has to be made a right, per their manifesto. Can there be a [more] hypothetical way of criticising others?

RK: Your supporters seem very upset that you’ve imposed taxes...

A: I want to ask where did I impose tax?

RK: On futures and options (F&O), you have increased taxes...

A: Who are these supporters? The so-called middle class, right? F&O is for the middle class? Please don’t mind me saying, ‘Why can’t the middle class be there?’ Of course they can be there. But F&O goes with risk. I’m not saying middle class shouldn’t go into F&O. And what is it that we’ve done? For options, the increase is even lesser; in futures it has doubled—from 0.0125% it has gone to 0.02%...

SIDDHARTH ZARABI: People say black money will be back after the removal of indexation benefits on long-term capital gains (LTCG) tax for real estate...

A: It’s nice to conflate many things onto this debate. Haven’t we as a country kept saying, ‘Why all this dif-

“If we didn’t think jobs were an important element of the economy, why would our cabinet notes have to have a section talking about what would be the impact on jobs?”

ferentiation between the different asset classes? Why can’t it be simple? Why don’t you rationalise it? That’s been one of the very strong arguments... I remember people telling me TCS, TDS... why are there so many rates? And again, for the middle class, I said, if there is TCS, you can carry it forward as a credit if you want into your TDS also... all inputs that have come from the middle class all these years...

RK: Your promise was of continuity and predictability. But for instance, you have increased LTCG tax on equity from 10% to 12.5%. You said in taxation, there’s always some unpredictability. When somebody makes an